
The Aging Body

Companion Workbook — shape your specific
approach to healthy aging

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

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Inner Circle Deep Cut — #11 Workbook

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Contents

1. How to use this workbook
2. Current Functional Baseline
3. Reflection Prompts
4. My Aging Trajectory Self-Assessment
5. My Function-Preservation Plan
6. Decade-Specific Focus
7. 30-Day Practice Tracker
8. Quarterly Re-Tests
9. Mental/Emotional Aging Check-In
10. Year-End Reflection
11. Try this for 30 days

Introduction

A YEAR-LONG COMPANION TO THE IC11 DEEP cut. Shape your specific approach to healthy aging.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

YEAR-LONG REFERENCE. FUNCTIONAL BASELINE first. Daily practice plan. Quarterly re-tests to track trajectory.

Bring it to every session and your annual physical.

CHAPTER 2

Current Functional Baseline

AGE: _ / DATE ASSESSED: _____

Mobility tests

Walking distance comfortable for me: _ miles or
___ minutes

Climbing one flight of stairs: ☐ Easy / ☐ Moderate / ☐ Difficult / ☐ Cannot

Getting up from floor without using hands: ☐ Easy / ☐ With effort / ☐ Need hands / ☐ Cannot

Carrying groceries from car: ☐ Easy / ☐ Moderate / ☐ Difficult / ☐ Cannot

Reaching overhead to top shelf: ☐ Easy / ☐ Moderate / ☐ Difficult / ☐ Cannot

Standing on one leg for 30 seconds: ☐ Easy / ☐ With wall / ☐ Cannot

Activity inventory

Daily movement practice: ☐ Daily / ☐ Most days / ☐ Sometimes / ☐ Rarely

Resistance training per week: _____ sessions

Cardio per week: _____ minutes

Sleep average: _____ hours

Stress management practice: ☐ Daily / ☐ Sometimes / ☐ None

10-year comparison

Compared to 10 years ago:

- Strength: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Energy: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Mobility: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Cognitive function: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Mood/wellbeing: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Sleep: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse

Activities I’ve stopped or reduced

Things I’ve stopped doing in the past 10 years:

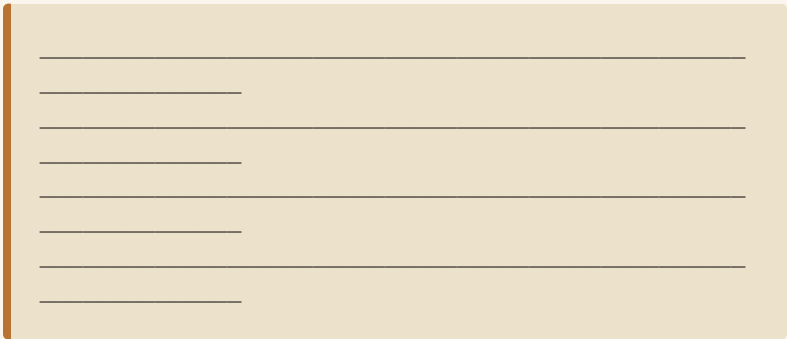
Why I stopped (be honest — was it really age, or was it choice/deconditioning?):

Activities I'd like to be able to do again or maintain:

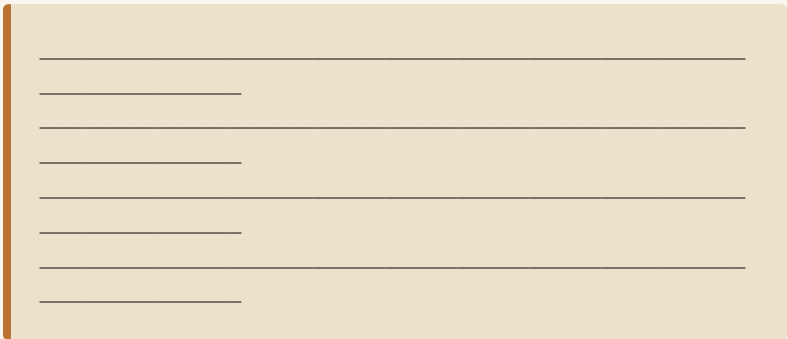
CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

PROMPT 1: PICTURE YOURSELF AT 80 (OR IF you're 80, picture yourself at 95). What capabilities do you most want to have at that age? What would you most regret losing?



Prompt 2: Who's the oldest person you know who's functioning impressively well? What patterns do you see in how they've lived? What can you adopt from their example?



Prompt 3: What's the story you tell yourself about your own aging? "I'm just getting older." "It's downhill from here." "I'll never be 25 again so why try." How accurate is the story? What's a more accurate story?

CHAPTER 4

My Aging Trajectory Self-Assessment

AM I CURRENTLY IN THE “THRIVING” OR
“declining” pattern?

- ☐ Clearly thriving — active, engaged, maintaining function
- ☐ Mostly thriving with some declines I’d like to address
- ☐ Mixed — some areas thriving, some declining
- ☐ Mostly declining — losing function faster than I’d like
- ☐ Significant decline pattern

Specific declines I’ve noticed:

Strengths I’ve maintained:

Trajectory if I keep doing what I'm doing for the next 5 years:

CHAPTER 5

My Function-Preservation Plan

Daily commitments

MOVEMENT PRACTICE (10-15 MIN):

Walking goal: ____ minutes per day

Sleep commitment: _ hours, bedtime , wake _

Stress practice: _____

Weekly commitments

Resistance training: _ sessions per week, ____ minutes each

Cardio: ____ minutes total per week

Social engagement: _____

Monthly commitments

Bodywork: Every ____ weeks (if affordable)

Annual commitments

Annual physical: Month: _____

Age-appropriate screenings due this year:

CHAPTER 6

Decade-Specific Focus

CHOOSE YOUR CURRENT DECADE AND IDENTIFY the priority focus:

If I'm in my 30s

Priority focus: - ☐ Building daily practice habits - ☐ Establishing sleep priority - ☐ Basic strength training - ☐ Stress management

Specific commitment for this decade:

If I'm in my 40s

Priority focus: - ☐ Adjusting training intensity for recovery - ☐ Not skipping recovery - ☐ Addressing sleep - ☐ Starting to track medical markers

Specific commitment:

If I'm in my 50s

Priority focus: - ☐ Resistance training for bone/muscle preservation - ☐ Sleep hygiene non-negotiable - ☐ Hormonal evaluation and management - ☐ Social maintenance

Specific commitment:

If I'm in my 60s

Priority focus: - ☐ Daily mobility non-negotiable - ☐ Balance work for fall prevention - ☐ Continued resistance training - ☐ Continued social engagement

Specific commitment:

If I'm in my 70s

Priority focus: - ☐ Continued use of all systems - ☐ Quick response to declines - ☐ Don't let health events cascade into decline - ☐ Bodywork as maintenance

Specific commitment:

If I’m in my 80s+

Priority focus: - [] Movement adapted to current capacity - [] Balance critical - [] Social and cognitive engagement - [] Medical proactivity

Specific commitment:

CHAPTER 7

30-Day Practice Tracker

TRACK DAILY FOR 30 DAYS TO ESTABLISH THE practice.

DAY	DATE	MOVE- MENT DONE?	SLEEP HOURS	WALKED?	ONE WORD ABOUT HOW I FEEL
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					
16					

DAY	DATE	MOVE- MENT DONE?	SLEEP HOURS	WALKED?	ONE WORD ABOUT HOW I FEEL
17					
18					
19					
20					
21					
22					
23					
24					
25					
26					
27					
28					
29					
30					

CHAPTER 8

Quarterly Re-Tests

RE-DO THE FUNCTIONAL BASELINE TESTS EVERY 3 months.

Q1 Re-Test — Date: ____

TEST	DAY 1	Q1
Walking comfortable		
Stairs		
Floor get-up		
Groceries		
Overhead reach		
One-leg stand		

Pattern noticed: _____

Q2-Q4 Re-Tests

Continue same format quarterly.

CHAPTER 9

Mental/Emotional Aging Check-In

DO THIS ANNUALLY.

Sense of meaning and purpose: [] Strong / [] Moderate / [] Weak

Quality of close relationships: [] Thriving / [] Adequate / [] Needs attention

Sense of contribution to others: [] Strong / [] Moderate / [] Weak

Continued learning and curiosity: [] Active / [] Some / [] Minimal

Emotional state generally: [] Good / [] OK / [] Struggling

Grief, loss, or trauma I'm carrying:

Support I have for the emotional side of aging:

Mental health professional (if applicable):

CHAPTER 10

Year-End Reflection

COMPARED TO ONE YEAR AGO, MY AGING
trajectory is:

- [] Significantly better — thriving more
- [] Somewhat better
- [] About the same
- [] Somewhat worse
- [] Significantly worse

Biggest accomplishment for my body this year:

What I'm grateful my body can still do:

Commitment for next year:

CHAPTER 11

Try this for 30 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK,
try this:

Daily 10-minute mobility practice + daily 20-minute walk + 8 hours of sleep. For 30 days.

These three basics, done consistently for 30 days, often produce measurable functional improvement at any age.

If you're 40 and curious how good your body can feel — try this.

If you're 70 and worried about decline — try this.

The body responds to consistent attention regardless of starting point.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
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Nate.